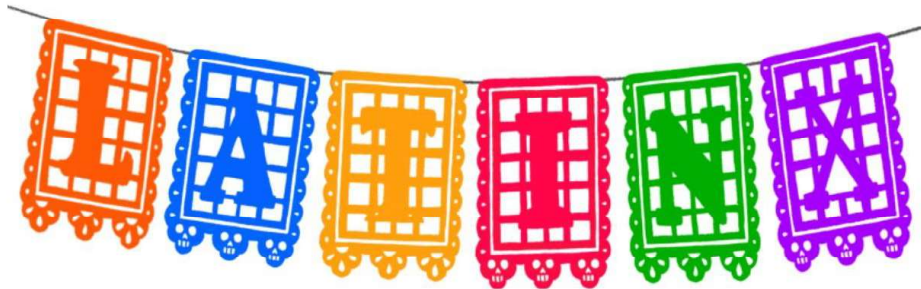
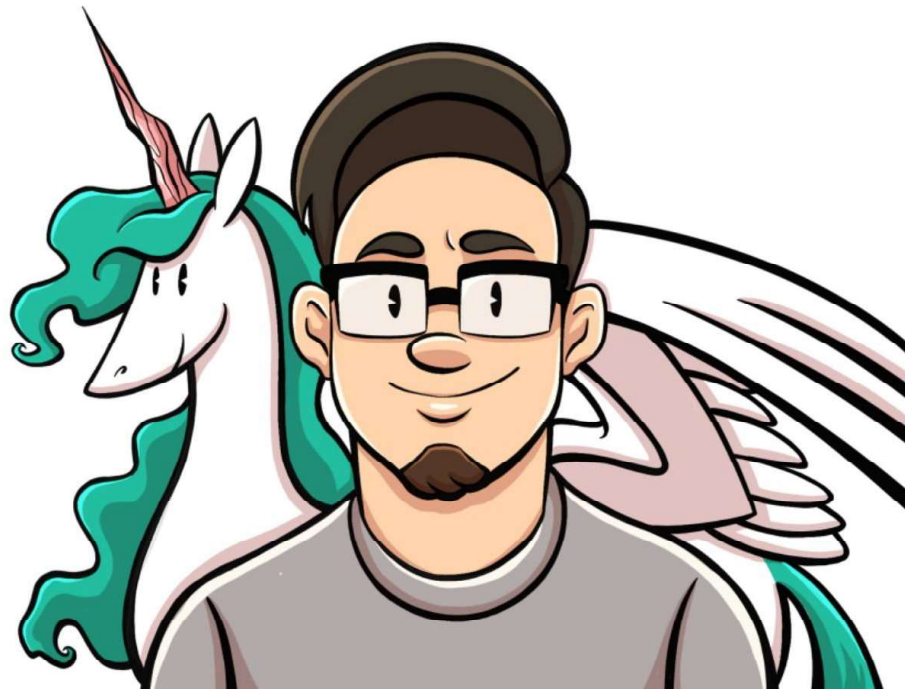


YOU SAY



ANOTHER **MINI COMIC** BY **TERRY BLAS**



HELLO!

I'M AUTHOR, ILLUSTRATOR,
AND COMIC BOOK MAKER...

TERRY BIAS!

I MADE A COMIC A WHILE
BACK ABOUT THE TERMS
LATINO AND *HISPANIC*.

SOME OF YOU *LOVED* IT.
SOME OF YOU *HATED* IT.

BUT THAT'S LIFE, RIGHT?

WELL, THERE'S ANOTHER
TERM THAT I THINK IS BEING
USED WIDELY NOW THAT IS
CONFUSING TO SOME PEOPLE.
THAT TERM IS...



LATINX



ACCORDING TO A WIDELY SHARED OP-ED IN A COLLEGE
NEWSPAPER, WRITTEN BY GILBERT ORBEA AND GILBERT GUERRA,
LATINX IS A TERM THAT CAME INTO POPULAR USE IN THE
UNITED STATES AROUND OCTOBER 2014. THEY SAY IT'S
PROBLEMATIC AT BEST, DUE TO ENGLISH SPEAKERS IMPOSING
SOCIAL NORMS ON OTHER CULTURES.

BECAUSE OF ITS DIFFERENT PRONUNCIATIONS AND BECAUSE IT'S A RELATIVELY NEW TERM USED MOSTLY IN THE UNITED STATES, IT'S EASY TO BE CONFUSED BY IT.

I PERSONALLY HAVEN'T HEARD MANY PEOPLE WHO LIVE IN SPANISH-SPEAKING COUNTRIES USE IT.



*RITA MORENO AS LYDIA RIERA ON ONE DAY AT A TIME, S O2 E 01.

SO WHY ISN'T IT USED AS MUCH IN SPANISH-SPEAKING COUNTRIES? I'M SURE THERE ARE SEVERAL REASONS, BUT MAYBE THIS IS ONE...

SPANISH...

LIKE FRENCH, PORTUGUESE, ITALIAN, ALONG WITH OTHER ROMANCE LANGUAGES, USES A MASCULINE-FEMININE NOUN CLASSIFICATION. IN OTHER WORDS:

ALL NOUNS ARE EITHER MASCULINE OR FEMININE.

SOME PEOPLE JUST SAY THESE ARE
"GENDERED LANGUAGES."



BEAR WITH ME. LET'S START HERE:

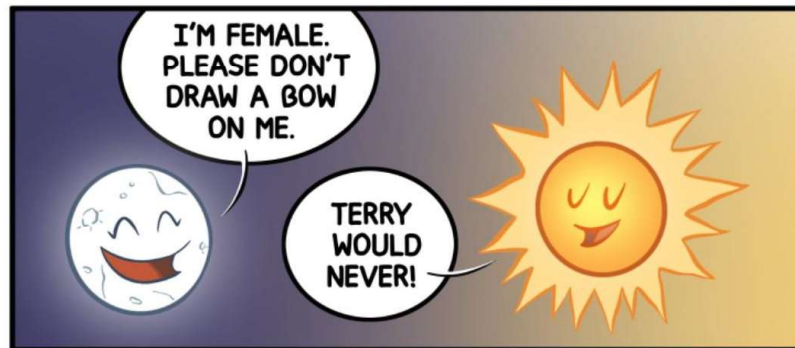
*IN SPANISH, THERE ARE TWO WORDS
FOR "THE."*

EL IS THE MASCULINE FORM OF "THE."

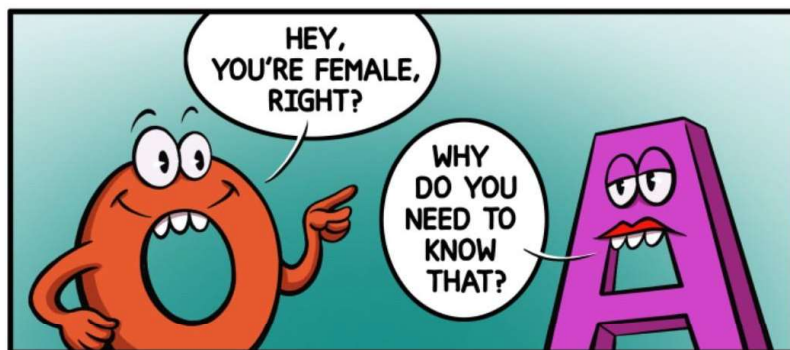
LA IS THE FEMININE FORM OF "THE."

HERE'S AN EXAMPLE OF BOTH USES OF "THE."

LA LUNA (THE MOON) EL SOL (THE SUN)

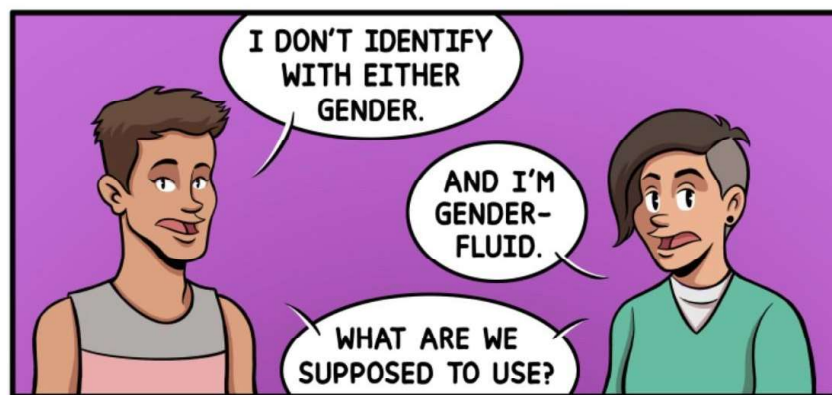


ALSO, THE LETTERS "O" AND "A" ARE USED TO INDICATE MALE AND FEMALE. THIS IS WHY PEOPLE SAY **LATINO** FOR MALE AND **LATINA** FOR FEMALE.



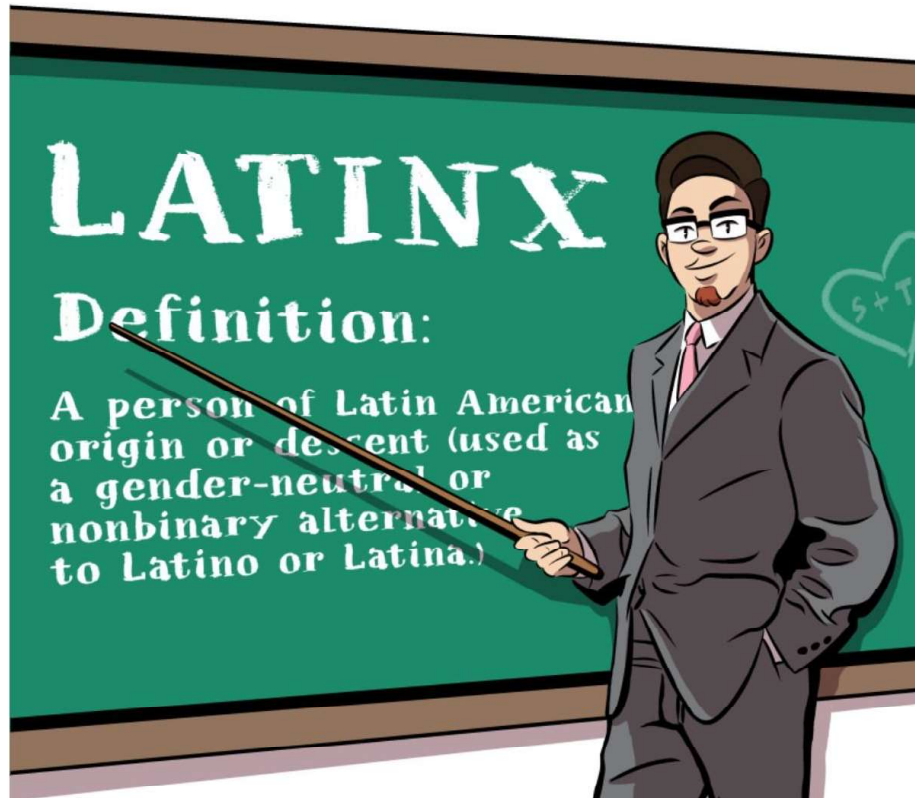
NOW HERE IS WHERE IT GETS TRICKY.

"O" IS ALSO THE LETTER USED WHEN REFERRING TO A COLLECTIVE GROUP OF MEN AND WOMEN. SO THE PLURAL WORD FOR A GROUP OF MALE AND FEMALE LATINOS IS... **LATINOS.**



WELL, HERE WE GO...

ONE SOLUTION MIGHT BE TO USE THIS:



BUT THIS ISN'T THE *ONLY* DEFINITION. IT'S JUST THE ONE THAT I FIND HELPS ME BEST UNDERSTAND THE TERM.

IF YOU FEEL THIS DEFINITION DOESN'T WORK FOR YOU, THAT'S FINE! DEFINITELY SEEK OUT YOUR OWN!

THE GILBERTS SAY THAT X AS A REPLACEMENT LETTER MAKES SPANISH UNPRONOUNCEABLE, NOT CONJUGATABLE, AND, FRANKLY, CONFUSING.



NOW, I'M NOT SOMEONE WHO THINKS *LANGUAGE* SHOULDN'T CHANGE. IT CHANGES ALL THE TIME. BUT I SORT OF FELT LOST AS TO WHAT A GOOD SOLUTION WAS THAT WOULD ALLOW FOR SPANISH TO STAY *SPEAKABLE*.

AND THEN I DISCOVERED A *MEXICAN DRAG COMPETITION* ON YOUTUBE CALLED:



LA MAS DRAGA!

SERIOUSLY,
WATCH IT.

I HAD NO IDEA, BUT
IT'S HOSTED BY A
FRIEND OF MINE,

JOHNNY CARMONA!



WHEN WELCOMING THE CONTESTANTS, HE USED
THESE WORDS:

¡BIENVENIDOS A TODOS!

(THE MALE FORM OF "WELCOME EVERYONE")

BUT HE *REPLACED* EVERY GENDERED VOWEL
WITH AN...

E

SO WHAT HE ACTUALLY SAID WAS:

¡BIENVENIDES A TODES!

IT BLEW MY MIND!
IT WAS INCLUSIVE *AND* EASY TO PRONOUNCE!



IT ROLLED OFF THE TONGUE! AND WHILE JOHNNY SAID HE'S BEEN CRITICIZED FOR USING "E," I FELT LIKE HE'D GIVEN ME SUCH A GREAT GIFT!

BESIDES, THERE'S ALWAYS GONNA BE HATERS. REMEMBER WHAT *RUPAUL* SAID:



PERSONALLY, I LIKE USING THE **E**. IT MAKES:

AMIGOS = AMIGUES

(G IN FRONT OF A, O, OR U HAS A HARD SOUND, SO YOU HAVE TO ADD A SILENT U. THIS IS A WHOLE DIFFERENT COMIC.)

